



YOU ARE **38 WEEKS AND 6 DAYS**  
**8 days to go...**

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### YOUR BABY TODAY

The movements that you feel will usually be concentrated in a few areas since your baby cannot readily change position. Although the character of these movements will have changed, you should still experience many movements each day.

**“Because you’re heading into the final week, you’re bound to feel a little anxious, but hopefully excited, too.”**

It’s normal to feel a little anxious about your impending labor, especially if it’s your first baby. Try not to keep your feelings bottled up: share anxieties with your partner, since you might find that they are in need of reassurance, too. Do confide in friends and family, but remember not to get drawn into stories of their birth experiences, or someone else they know, as these can often add to feelings of anxiety!

If you have specific concerns, call your midwife. She’ll be used to handling these worries and will be able to put your mind at rest.

Plan your time to keep busy and active, but always be aware of your limitations at this stage of pregnancy and invite people to visit you at home, rather than you visiting them. An ideal outing in this final couple of weeks might be a gentle stroll in your local park with a friend or relative.

### ASK A DOCTOR

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**What are the signs that it’s too late to go to the hospital?** If you’re having an uncontrollable urge to push, then that’s the point where it may be too late to reach the hospital before your delivery.

If you do find yourself in this situation, call your doctor who will advise you. They may arrange to send paramedics to you for the delivery of the baby. Or you can contact the emergency ambulance services yourself and follow their advice while you wait for their arrival.

### FOCUS ON PARTNERS

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**As your partner’s primary support,** you have the difficult job of trying to take charge, exude calm, and give emotional and practical support. Don’t hesitate to call the doctor—a short discussion may help you to gauge how far your partner has progressed. You must allow plenty of time to get to the hospital and you should be familiar with the route.

There may be periods when your partner is not lucid, but you will know what she wants better than anyone else. It’s therefore your role to advocate for her and to engage with the medical staff